

BASEBALL CHATTER

Tribe Manager Cohen Held In High Esteem

By MAX GREENWALD
Star Sports Writer

St. Paul, Minn.—Indianapolis baseball fans are just getting acquainted with the Tribe's new manager, Andy Cohen, but they can get an insight to the type of person he is by listening to his friends in Minneapolis.

"He is remembered as one of Minneapolis' all-time great ones," said Dick Cullum in his "Cullum's Column" in the Minneapolis Star.

Cohen was welcomed back to the Twin Cities where he was a favorite from 1932 until 1939. He was an infielder with Minneapolis in those years.

Before that, John McGraw, manager of the New York Giants, watched the young shortstop in spring training at Waco, Tex. For years McGraw had been seeking a Jewish player and the day the Giants' pilot was looking on, Cohen hit a home run over the left center fence.

McGraw signed Cohen, who stayed with the Giants three years, hitting mostly singles as he averaged .280. He was just a bit deficient in power, just a bit short of Major League fielding range, either at shortstop or at second base.

AS CULLUM points out, he did not miss by much but joined the ranks "of those known as great minor leaguers."

"There is such a category. It comprises men who have keen baseball minds, fine competitive spirit, all-around skills. They are baseball men in the truest sense; but each lacks one supreme skill which would make him outstanding in the big leagues.

"Cohen was a ball player's ball player. The moves he made were not spectacular but opponents realized he was always hurting them by being where he belonged, doing the right thing.

"He is remembered as one of Minneapolis' all-time great ones. He helped the Millers win mainly by never helping them lose. They say baseball games are lost, not won. Well, Andy never lost any.

"Now he is in the American Association and mighty welcome.

"His old friends in Minneapolis wish him well and hope he stays around for a long time or until something better shows up for him."

There you are, Andy, quite a bouquet.

WHEN HE signed his Major League contract with Cleveland, Roger Maris also received a \$10,000 bonus.



ROGER MARIS

"I feel I can take it," said the outfielder who was at Indianapolis last year. "I've been hitting lefthanded pitching real good and Kerby Farrell has given me a good chance."

That lefthanded pitching especially referred to Billy Pierce of the White Sox, who was solved by Maris for four hits in two games.

THE NEW YORK Yankees showed "bad taste" in signing one of his players, says the coach of the Fresno, Cal., State College baseball team.

Pete Beiden also had a few unkind words about the collegian involved, Harry Mayo, a sophomore outfielder.

Mayo was signed by Yankee scouts Deacon Jones and Tony Robello for just under the \$4,000 bonus limit and assigned to Modesto of the Class C California League.

"Signing of Mayo was news to me," said Beiden. "I think the boy should have

at least had the courtesy to let me know about it and I definitely think it was in poor taste on the part of Jones and Robello.

"It is bad enough when they take a boy before the season starts or after it is over but when they sign him after the season is in progress I think it is showing bad taste.

"I am happy when our boys can play professional ball and I never stand in a boy's way. But it is a sad thing when you go to all the trouble to contact a boy, finally get him in school and have him leave in the first month of the season."

HIT-AND-RUN—The Evansville club has arranged for a bus line to take fans to the Three-I opener today and return them home after the game. It will be free service for the fans . . . Mickey Witek, former Giants' infielder, is an umpire in a Pennsylvania semipro league.

Louisville games are being broadcast this season for the first time since 1955 . . . Minneapolis sent Outfielder Eric Rodin to Little Rock and he is undergoing treatment for a sore right arm.

The nine pitchers Al Lopez will depend on this season average 34 years in age. Jack Harshman and Dick Donovan, at 29, are the youngest . . . Jackie Robinson's new boss never has seen a big league ball game.

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